

*“Five asks in the brief.
One underlying problem.
Three commitments by day 90.”*

CASH FIRST · TRUTH SECOND · DISCIPLINE THIRD

Building Confidence

A practical 90-day plan to turn a cash-flow problem into a forecast the board can believe.

01 · DAYS 1-30

Cash

Stop the bleeding, make runway visible.

02 · DAYS 31-60

Truth

One definition, one source per number.

03 · DAYS 61-90

Discipline

Make fixed-price growth safe to scale.

Five working assumptions

The brief invited assumptions. Only the first materially changes the decisions that follow.

DECISION-SHAPING

- 1

Net cash consumption is $\approx$ €850k per month.

This drives urgency. At this burn rate, runway is measured in weeks, not quarters.
- 2

Collection odds fall as receivables age.

Receivables must be managed by age and owner — not treated as one balance.
- 3

Digital assets are valued once a day, at the same time.

One timestamp, one rule, no debates.
- 4

No new funding arrives in the 90-day window.

The plan must work with the cash already available.
- 5

Finance stays a four-person team through day 90.

The plan is sized to today's team. No hiring asks before diagnosis.

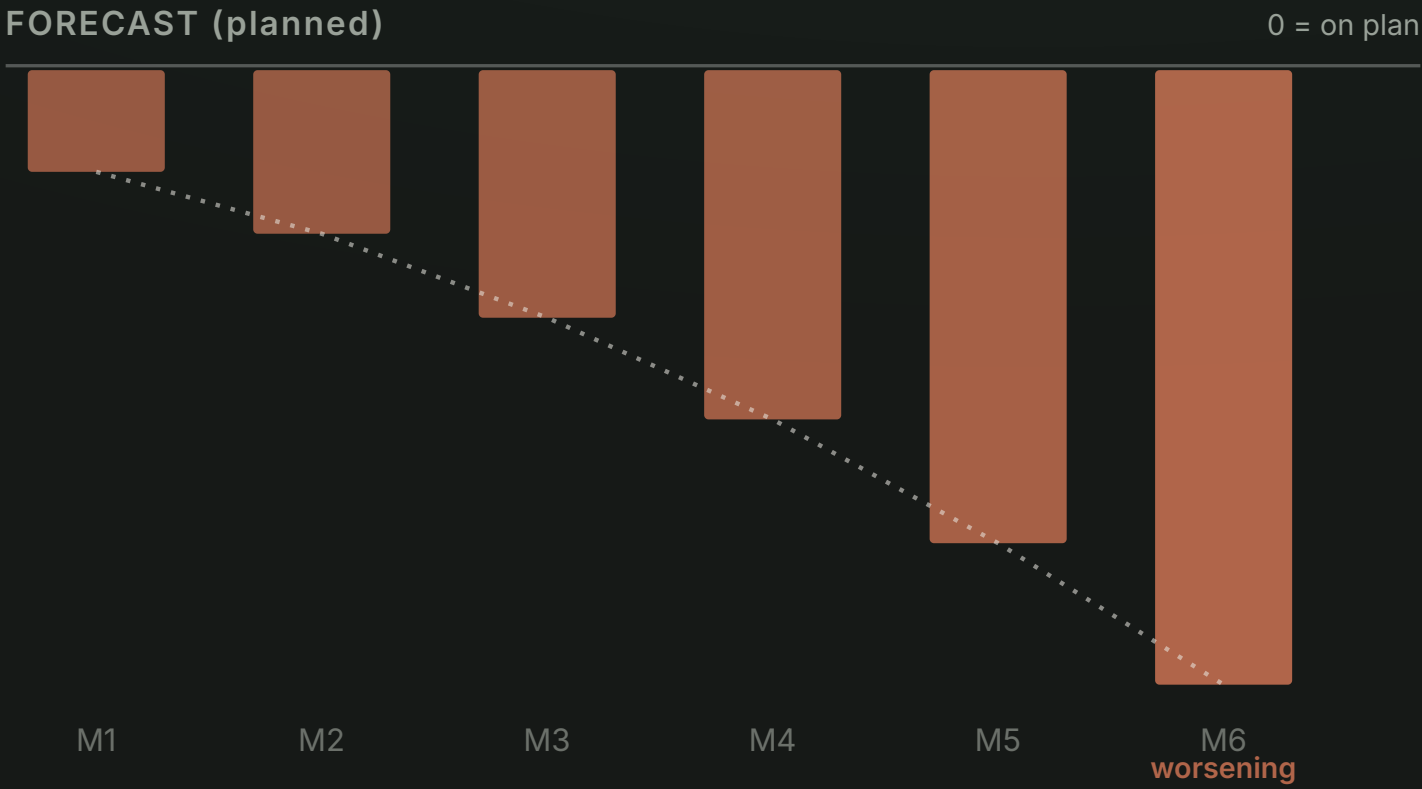
◆ This is a confidence plan, **not a transformation programme.**

The forecast is not noisy. It is biased.

6 of 6
misses in the same direction

Random error goes both ways. Same-direction misses that keep getting worse mean the model is blind to known drivers — vendor bills, bonus timing, how clients actually pay, and how delivery data reaches finance.

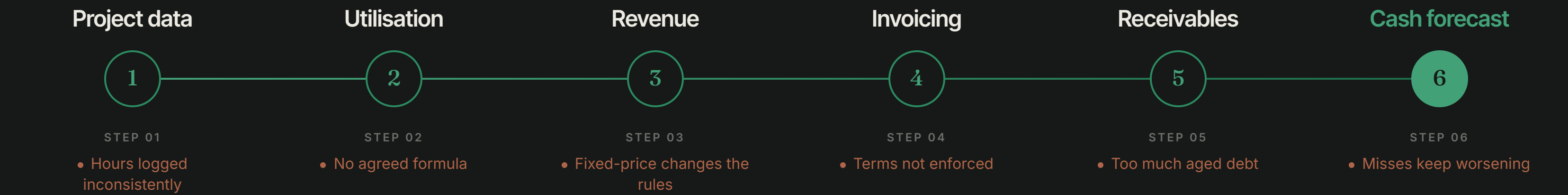
THE GOOD NEWS
Bias is fixable in weeks. Noise is not.



Cash forecast miss vs actual — last six months. Every bar overshoots; the gap only widens.

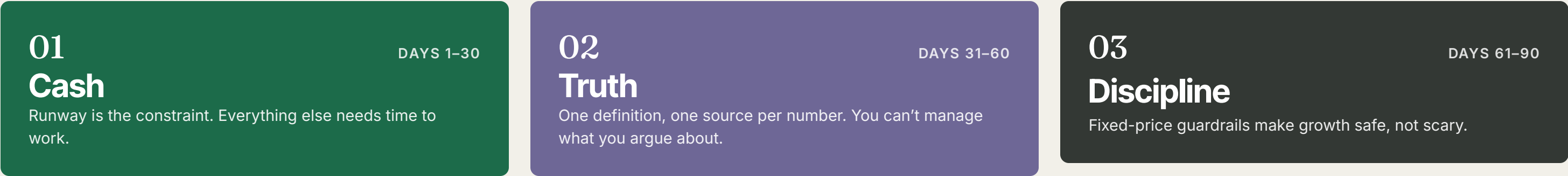
Every ask in the brief is a break in **one pipeline**

Data accuracy, collections, forecasting, the KPI question and the fixed-price shift are one revenue-to-cash spine.



◆ Fix the spine once. Then hang quick wins from it.

Three journeys, one order



People Ownership & alignment	Name owners; build delivery relationships	Utilisation agreed with delivery	Margin accountability per project
Processes Operating cadence	Weekly forecast & collections plays	Forecast cadence, margin reviews	Change orders & margin tripwire
Platforms & data Single sources of truth	13-week cash view, timestamp rule	KPI dictionary, scorecard v2	Fixed-price economics, both models

◆ Forecasting is not a phase. It is the output when collections behave and the data is trusted.

Stop the bleeding, see the truth

Five moves in the first 30 days. Each has one owner and a dated target.

DAY 10

13-week cash view, refreshed every Friday

Bank feeds plus a manual receivables & payables layer. Accuracy beats false precision.

Live by day 10

DAY 12

Weekly Cash Council, 30 minutes

CEO, CFO, delivery lead. Money in, money out, decisions needed — and made.

First session day 12

DAY 15

Receivables split into five groups, one owner each

Different ageing groups need different plays, not one reminder.

Owners named day 15

DAY 20

Digital-asset treasury rule

Convert above a working buffer; value at the same daily timestamp.

Policy live day 20

DAY 25

Listening tour: PMs, delivery leads, finance

Find where each scorecard number actually comes from.

Done by day 25

◆ No hire, no system, no budget — all five run on the team we already have.

€1.8m owed to us: five problems, five plays

€1.8m Total receivables outstanding	€790k Sitting beyond 60 days — losing value weekly	€530–690k 30-day collection target	≈ 2 weeks Extra runway if we collect half of the aged debt
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GROUP	AMOUNT	THE PLAY	OWNER	30-DAY TARGET
■ Disputes · 90+ days	€375k	Settle or escalate within 30 days. A fast haircut beats receivables that lose value every week.	CFO + CEO	€150–190k
■ Slow payers · 61–90	€330k	Reminder ladder with real teeth; work pauses at day 45 overdue where the contract allows.	Account Head	€180–220k
■ DAO / crypto clients	€252k	Payment-mechanism mismatch. Fix the contract: deposits or escrow going forward.	CFO	€80–120k
■ Watch list · 31–60	€333k	Early intervention — before a delay becomes a dispute.	Account Head	€120–160k
■ Healthy · 0–30	€515k	Do nothing. Never annoy the clients who pay on time.	—	On terms

One version of the truth

01
Scorecard v2 — eight numbers

Each number gets a contract, not just a cell in a spreadsheet.

Contract = definition · formula · source system · owner · update rhythm

02
The utilisation summit

Finance and delivery in one room. The formula gets agreed, written down and signed.

03
Forecast v2 — blind spots added

Vendor bills, bonus timing, real payment behaviour and the digital-asset timestamp.

CASH WEEKLY

Cash position01

Weekly

Forecast accuracy02

Weekly

Owed over 60 days03

Weekly

DELIVERY WEEKLY

Utilisation04

Weekly

Margin left per project05

Weekly

Project profitability06

Monthly

COMMERCIAL MONTHLY

Recognised revenue07

Monthly

Qualified pipeline08

Monthly

Cash first. Delivery second. Commercial third.

What fixed-price actually changes

AREA	BILLING BY THE HOUR · TODAY	FIXED-PRICE AMBITION	TOUCHES
Revenue	Hours billed equals revenue. Simple.	Revenue follows project progress — which depends on honest estimates.	FORECASTING
Cash	Invoice after the work, then wait.	Deposits & milestones: cash arrives before the work, not after.	COLLECTIONS
Risk	Overruns are the client’s cost.	Overruns are our margin. Two poor projects can lose 20+ points.	MARGIN
Data	Timesheets exist to bill.	Timesheets control cost — hours left, WIP, both models side by side.	DATA ACCURACY
Pricing	Rate card.	Risk-priced: less certain estimate, higher price. Margin managed across the portfolio.	MARGIN

◆ Done right, fixed-price **helps** the cash problem — a 30% deposit on a €300k deal is **€90k in the bank before an hour is worked.**

The ambition is right. The **sequencing** is the risk.

01

Scoping template
Deliverables, acceptance criteria and exclusions — in writing, every time.

02

Risk-priced buffer
Uncertainty is charged for, not absorbed into margin.

03

Mandatory change orders
Scope moves, price moves — signed before any extra work starts.

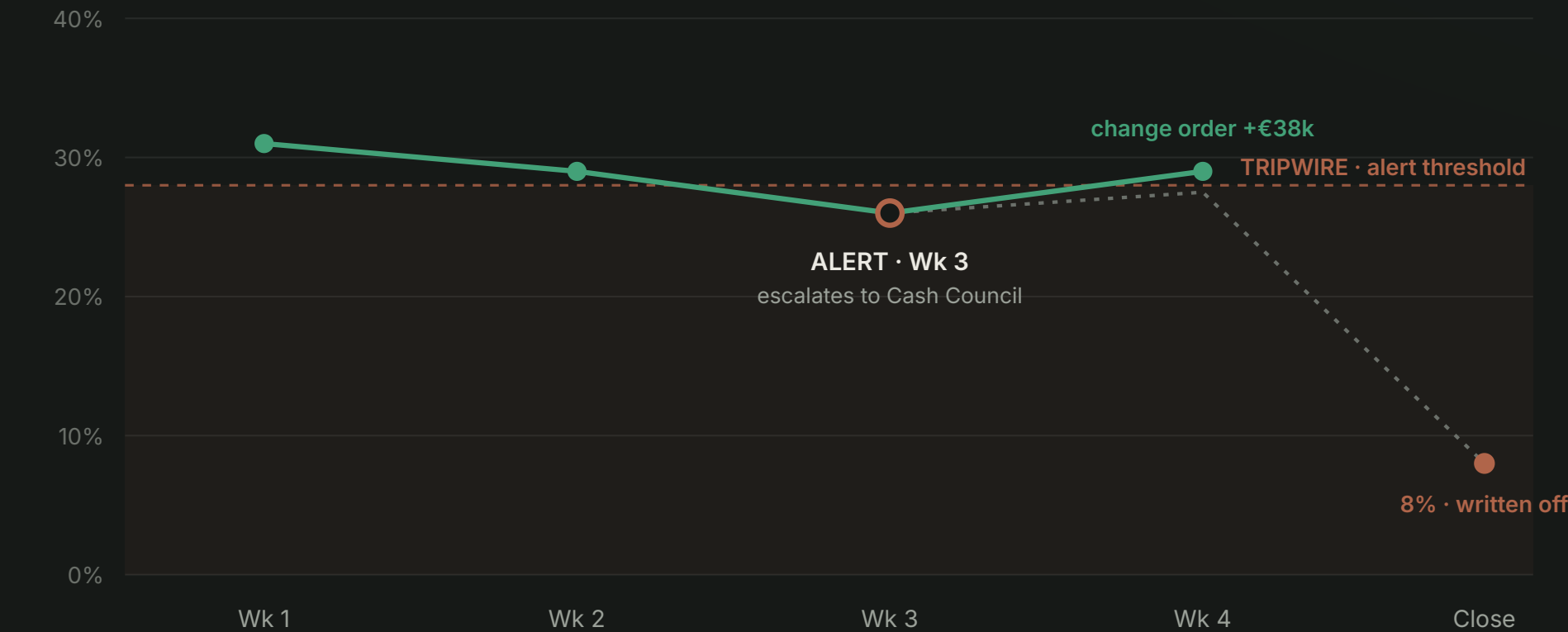
04

Margin tripwire
Weekly review of hours left versus money left, per project.

READINESS
GATE

No new fixed-price deal above **€150k** until we have **eight weeks of trusted utilisation data**, agreed with delivery.

Same project, new regime: Cygnus replayed



14 weeks

The alarm rings 14 weeks earlier.

The tripwire does not stop estimates being wrong. It stops wrong estimates staying **invisible** — while there is still time to act.

New regime — caught at Week 3

Old regime — found at close, -27 pts

What I commit to — and what I refuse to promise



LIVE BY DAY 90

Three commitments

- 01 **13-week cash view** — updated weekly, accuracy tracked, misses shrinking.
- 02 **Receivables under management** — five groups, one owner each; decisions executed on both 90+ day disputes.
- 03 **Scorecard v2** — eight numbers, each with one definition, one source and one owner.



EXPLICITLY NOT IN 90 DAYS

Four things I won't promise

- **No new ERP or systems.** The problem is definitions and ownership, not software.
- **No real-time everything.** Weekly and trusted beats real-time and disputed.
- **No fixed-price at 40% of revenue.** The readiness gate comes first.
- **No hiring requests before diagnosis.** By day 90 the FP&A question is answered with evidence, not instinct.

Three asks. **None of them is budget.**

01

30 minutes a week

The CEO joins the weekly Cash Council for the first eight weeks. Decisions get made where the cash picture is.

02

A mandate on the two disputes

Authority to settle or escalate the 90+ day disputes — including accepting a commercial haircut for speed.

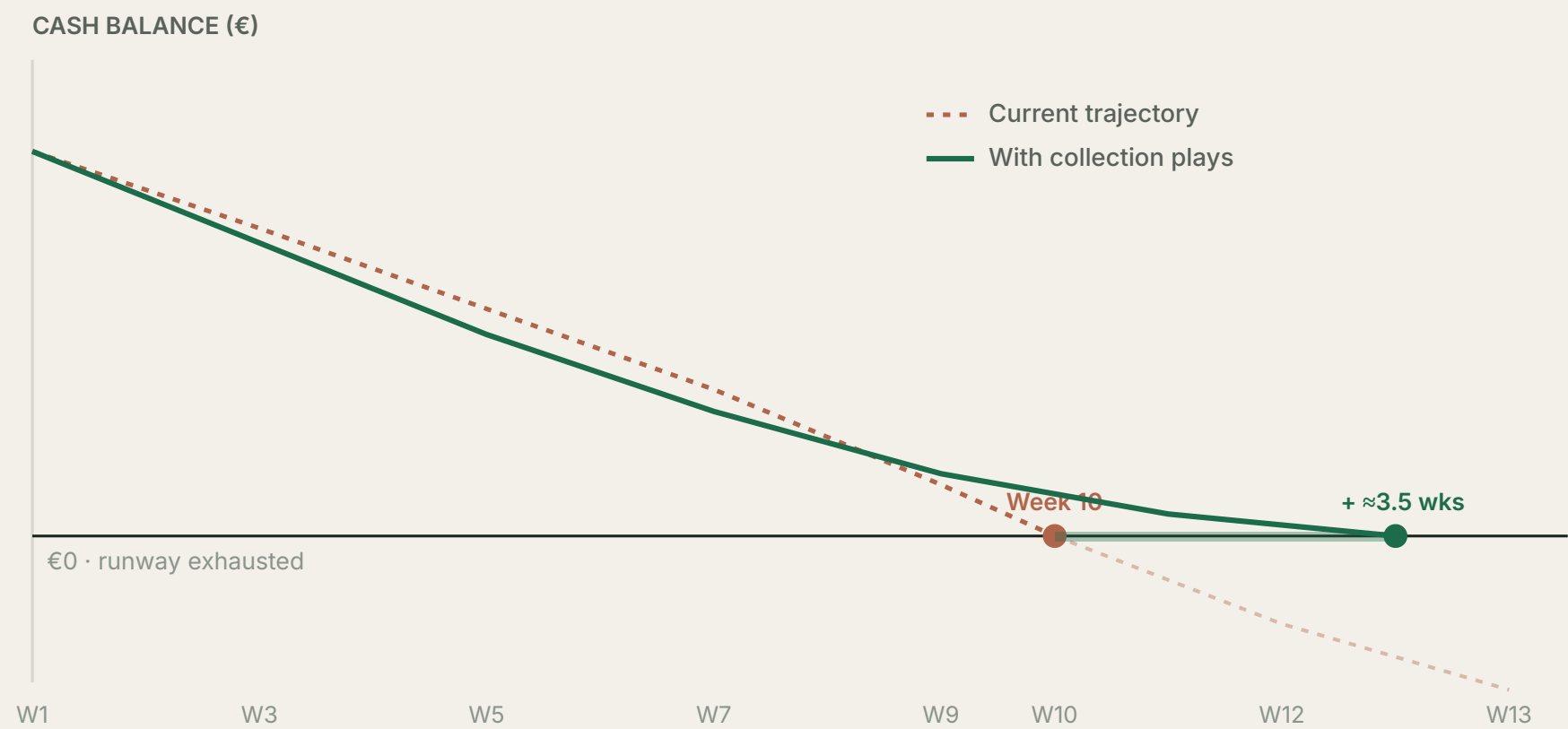
03

Delivery co-owns utilisation

The definition is agreed jointly. A number only finance believes is a number nobody uses.

Give me those three, and by day 90 confidence stops being a word on a slide. It becomes **a forecast you believe, a receivables book with owners, and a fixed-price model you can scale without flinching.**

The 13-week cash view: why weeks matter



THE COUNTDOWN

Week 10 is where the current trajectory **crosses zero**.

WHAT THE PLAYS BUY

The plays buy **≈ 3.5 weeks** — funding the structural fixes: billing rhythm, cost line, and a forecast that stops surprising us.

THE POINT

Not a problem solved. **A countdown converted into a plan.**